

OREGON CITY COURIER

33d Year

OREGON CITY, OREGON, THURSDAY, SEPTEMBER 2, 1915

Number 24

COUNCIL BACKS GOOD ROAD PLAN

OFFERS COUNTY CITY'S PART
OF HIGHWAY FUNDS FOR
NEARBY BETTERMENT

JITNEY ORDINANCE IS PASSED

Pool Halls Hit Again, and Downtown
Streets Ordered Improved with
Hard Surface Paving

Oregon City's council Wednesday night unanimously passed a resolution advising the county court to avail itself of the offer of the Warwick paving concern to hard surface the county road between the Abernathy bridge and Gladstone, at a cost of a dollar a yard; and further offered to the county the use of the municipality's share of road taxes in part payment for the work. Every councilman present—and they were all there—signed the resolution, and a delegation of city officials were ordered to present it to the county court.

The resolution recites that the council believes the improvement of this stretch of road with hard surface will be of great benefit to Oregon City, that it considers the Warwick paving a good investment and the offered price a real bargain; and it strings the council's approval of the plan by the county commissioners. The resolution was passed without any adverse comment; and was the most businesslike proceeding of the evening.

Not having met for some weeks, however, the council couldn't have been expected to do more than one or two real businesslike things; and some of the other acts on the program were of a different nature. For instance, there was the passage of the jitney ordinance and its sequel.

The jitney ordinance, fostered by Councilman Templeton, deals within Oregon City except under franchise granted by the council. It specifically does not apply to street cars, hotel busses, taxicabs and sight-seeing cars. When it came up for final passage, Mr. Meyer moved its adoption. Councilman Albright opposed it, saying that he did not see wherein it would benefit the public, and charged that it was framed in the interests of the Portland Railway, Light & Power company. After considerable discussion, in which the ordinance was defended by Metzner, Long and Meyer, and in which Meyer intimated that it would be a boon to jitney operators "because it would insure them protection in their business," Mr. Templeton accepted Albright's challenge, and said:

"Admitting that the ordinance was drawn in the interests of the Portland Railway, Light & Power company, should not they be protected? They pay taxes to the city, maintain a regular schedule, run their cars on time, pay for the upkeep of a portion of the streets, and they are always where you can find them."

Mr. Albright said he didn't see why the council should drive out the Portland jitneys and force Oregon City people to ride on the interurban line. "Some people like to go on the jitneys," he said, "they get fresh air, see pretty scenery, and have a good time."

The ordinance passed, with Councilman Van Auker, the local jitney king, voting for it, among others. Mr. Van Auker formerly bitterly opposed the jitney ordinance, but after he assisted in passing it a proposed franchise was introduced that gave to "Earl D. Van Auker" the right to operate a jitney or jitneys over all the streets and alleys of Oregon City, just about as he saw fit. Mr. Van Auker's jitneys will not have to keep any schedule, there is no mention made of the fare he may charge, he may cease running for any time less than two months any time he wants to and his franchise is good for five years. The document also contains this interesting clause:

"The rights and privileges herein granted are granted SOLELY to the said Earl D. Van Auker," and further provides that he can neither sell, assign or transfer them.

City Attorney Schuebel, when asked, said that was not an exclusive franchise.

It will come up for final action September 17. No consideration is asked for the franchise, and the only control has over it is that of Mr. Van Auker at any time does not operate his little jit for two months, he can be ordered to resume operations within five days.

Early in the evening a delegation of Mt. Pleasant folk asked the council to appropriate \$600 to improve with crushed rock a portion of Holmes lane, which lies on the city line. The county would pay an equal amount to better the street. Councilman Templeton had an economy fit over it, declared that if he could prevent it the city would "not go one solitary cent further in debt," and on motion got the application turned down.

Shortly after this economical out-

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GEORGE HAS FINEST SCHEME OF ALL FOR PICKING NEXT MAYOR

There is no doubt about it; George C. Brownell is the cleverest politician uncaptured in Clackamas county. This week ye humble scribe asked George whom he thought stood the best chance of being elected mayor of Oregon City, Deputy Sheriff Hackett, William E. Andersen, or City Recorder John Loder.

George meditated upon the problem, while ye scribe catalogued the various "vote-getting" points of the three possible candidates. And when ye scribe had finished his infantile babble, George spoke; saying: "Mebbe so, mebbe so; but it seems to me that if you want to pick a winner, you ought to pick a woman. Oregon City has had everything except a woman mayor, and if you give it a chance it will vote for one."

Who will be the first lady to oblige?

NOTED SPEAKER HERE

R. O. Hadley To Discuss European War at W. O. W. Hall

Sunday evening, at Woodmen of the World hall, Main street, Oregon City, Prof. R. O. Hadley will deliver an interesting and timely lecture upon the subject: "The Outcome of the Present European War." Prof. Hadley is a speaker of much force, and as a



Prof. R. O. Hadley

thinker ranks high among American intellectual leaders. He has been a deep student of current events, and believes that he has conclusive evidence that the Scriptures contain a solution of the problem that is at present baffling all nations of the eastern hemisphere.

Prof. Hadley affirms that the Bible and the Bible only, offers a satisfactory solution of the present distressing situation in the old world, and promises the presentation of Bible truths relative thereto which will be of striking interest to all. The lecture is free, and there will be no collection; Mr. Hadley being desirous of bringing his points to the attention of as many as can attend. In view of the fact that the world's greatest men and women are now engaged in an effort to find some way of ending the terrible European conflict, the lecture should be well worth hearing.

"JIT" SOME SLEUTH

Councilman Van Auker Discovers "Gambling Den" in Town

"Jit" Van Auker, as they are calling Councilman Van Auker these days, is surely some sleuth-hound, when it comes down to cases. At one of the recent executive sessions of the Oregon City dads, when moral conditions were being discussed, Mr. Van Auker volunteered the information that Louis Noble was running a "gambling den" right on Main street, and right next to the sacred precincts of the city hall. He said he knew it, because he had seen men sitting at the tables on two occasions with "great stacks of money in front of them."

Investigation was prompt—and without Mr. Van Auker's assistance. It was discovered that men had been sitting at the tables with money in front of them. On one occasion a carnival company had "counted out" its earnings there, and another time a contractor had gone there to pay his men off, and naturally took the money with him.

When Louis Noble heard about it all he heaved a sigh. "It is too bad," said he, "to have my reputation ruined like that after twenty years, and especially now, when I have to serve soda water to make a living."

Mr. Van Auker is the same councilman who put up five dollars once to discover a great scandal about another councilman—and who hasn't yet dared to tell what he found out.

The Courier doesn't attempt to be a near-city paper—but it is one of the best local papers in the state. \$1.00 a year in advance.

BIG HOP FIELD REGION MAGNET

HUNDREDS LEAVE FOR JOBS
PICKING VINES IN
UPPER VALLEY

LOW WAGES DETER BUT FEW

Yield Not Expected to be as Good as in Former Years, Owing to Poor Weather and Parasites

With the hop-growers relenting at the last minute and deciding to pay 40 cents instead of 35 per basket to pickers, hundreds this week left their homes in northern Oregon for the great hop field section of the Willamette valley. Though wages before the hop-growers decided to "punish" the people for voting the state dry were 50 cents a basket, many people have decided that the 40 cents is well worth going after, and have packed up baggage and tents and gone on the "annual Oregon pilgrimage."

Scores have gone to the hop fields from all sections of Clackamas county, though some more lucky people will spend their annual outing picking at home. However, hops in this county are not as far advanced as those further south, where picking commenced last week; so the stay-at-homes will have a chance for cool weather before going out to the shady sides of the vines. The exceptional warm weather at the start of the hop picking season has proved a detriment to speedy work in many yards, and many women pickers have been forced to quit their exertions in the middle of the day.

Owing to the great amount of wet weather earlier in the year, many of the hop-yards will not show good yields, the vines having failed to mature well. However, many other yards report conditions of the best, so the grade of the year's crop will probably average as well as formerly. Lice have done much damage to the vines this year, according to report from many yards; and experts say that the total yield will not exceed 100,000 to 115,000 bales. Earlier in the year it was estimated that the crop would amount to 150,000 bales.

Hop-growers are not worrying much about sales. While the spreading wave of prohibition has materially hurt the brewing industry, and so had a bearish effect on hop prices, the shortage in the expected European yield owing to the war will make a good demand for American hops, so it is not expected that prices will fall much below the average. In fact the decision of association growers to raise the price from 35 to 40 cents a basket is a pretty good indication of their anticipation of a good profit when it comes to selling.

Trouble among the hop pickers is not expected in any of the big yards. Reports have come in from a yard near Salem that pickers were working slowly and were intending to strike for the 50-cent rate after the season was well under way and all help engaged; but it is not believed that this amounts to more than an empty threat.

Systematized grafting schemes and plans which have been worked with much profit to certain parties in the past will be done away with to a great extent in the hop fields of Marion and Polk counties this year according to several well known growers. A crusade on the short-weight grocery keeper who secures concessions in the hop field will be "up against it" due to the fact that the owners of the yards are going to operate the establishments themselves. A ban is to be placed on the professional sharpers who infest the fields for the purpose of getting up little games around the camps in the evenings and the ticket scalper is going to have a hard row to hoe if he shows his hand. In other words the pickers are to be protected this year, and the growers intend to see to it that their employees get a square deal all the way round.

While general reports from the hop section are encouraging, there are some pessimists among those who have been over the different yards. Among these is J. S. Cooper, Jr., who is quoted in the Oregon Messenger as saying:

"In the Jefferson and Independence districts, the hops are generally in good condition and are clean although there are several yards there that will not produce enough to cover cost of raising. In a few cases unless there is a great improvement in the next few days the yards will never be picked. The worst district on the east side is in the lower region of Marion county, where there are a great many yards that will never be picked. The hot weather of the last few days has brought some of the yards out to a certain extent but there are yards that were so far gone that it will be impossible to get any hops."

It is even reported that some of the growers who have been hit the worst, are selling their baling cloth and supplies, as they do not expect to have any use for them. The destruc-

HE CAME; HE LOOKED; HE REALLY TRIED TO REMAIN; AND HE WENT

James Clifford Safely, of Moline, Ill., heard about Oregon City, and after copious correspondence with a local paper he left Moline and came to Oregon City to take a job as night editor of the Enterprise. He came because he wanted to see the west, and because he had heard of the attractions of this section.

James Clifford Safely arrived in Oregon City Monday morning. He spent the day looking over the community. He met George C. Brownell, Constable Jack Frost, the Hon. Gordon E. Hayes, Christian Schuebel, and many other celebrities. He saw the public elevator, the new pavement on Main street, and the place where the Falls of the Willamette are on Sundays and during high water. And he worked at his new job Monday night. Also he telegraphed to Moline, Ill., to see if his old job was still open.

Tuesday morning he got a telegram saying that he could have his former job if he could get back before anybody else beat him to it.

James Clifford Safely left Oregon City Tuesday at noon for Moline, Ill. Somehow he didn't appreciate the town.

CARVER "STRIKE STORY" DENIED

PRESIDENT OF PORTLAND AND
OREGON CITY ROAD IN-
DIGNANT AT TALE

WORK PROGRESSING SWIFTLY

Local Service Between Clackamas and
Milwaukie Postponed, owing to
Near Completion of Line

Stephen Carver, president of the Portland & Oregon City Railway, would very much like to know who was responsible for the weird and wonderful story printed in the Enterprise this week regarding a "strike" of 25 laborers engaged in tamping ballast upon the new railroad that will tap the heart of the rich Clackamas valley and give that section direct communication with Portland. Mr. Carver says there has been no strike, and no change in the working force, with the exception of one man; and also denies that there has been any wholesale reduction of wages. The one man laid off was a foreman, and he was temporarily put on the "waiting list" because there was nothing for him to "biss."

According to the Enterprise "discontent alleged to have been caused by the builder cutting their wages 25 cents a day, resulted in no less than 25 of the Armenian laborers, employed on the construction work of the Portland & Oregon City railroad, near Milwaukie, quitting their job yesterday and leaving for Independence, where jobs are said to be awaiting them at the wages which they originally received from the Carver road. The laborers were hired at \$1.75 per day for 10 hours, but a few days ago it was decided to cut them to \$1.50, and this proved to be too much for the Armenians, who are said to be better workmen than the ordinary Italian and other foreigners usually employed in railroad work, and they struck forthwith. Local merchants found the Armenians to be buyers of a better class of groceries and merchandise than many railroad builders and their trade will be missed."

President Carver characterized this

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tion of these yards is due to the lice and honeydew. In the heavy bottom yards of the Independence district the growers are used to lice each year and are used to spraying. In the yards where the growers sprayed early the lice and honeydew have been eradicated, but on the uplands where they have not been bothered a great deal with lice, the growers put off the spraying or used poor methods until it was too late.

"The honeydew this year has been worse than for a long time. The general idea is that the honeydew is a direct result of the lice but in some yards where the lice have not been very heavy the dew has been worse than where there were more aphids. This is attributed to the fact that the honeydew may come from the lice or from a weakness in the plant itself. It is expected that the government experts will make a thorough investigation of the conditions of this year. Dr. W. W. Stockberger, the government hop expert, is now in the Valley and it is expected that he will go into the matter thoroughly this fall."

ECONOMY RULES IN ROAD OILING

WORK COST COUNTY BUT SEVEN
CENTS OVER \$346 WHEN
ACCOUNTS CLOSED

JOB DONE IN EXCELLENT WAY

Criticisms of County Court by Estacada Paper Answered Fully
by Judge Anderson

It cost Clackamas county \$346.07 to oil the main traveled roads in the heart of the Willamette valley this year.

The actual expenditure was held down to this sum by the county court because no attention was paid to the request of the automobile clubs for oiling of highways mostly used by pleasure vehicles; and because the work of oiling the thoroughfares was managed in such a way that only stretches of road that actually needed the dressing were treated to an oil bath. No oil was used on asphaltic surfaces laid this year, and on the River road only a very small amount of dressing was placed on the surfaces that were in good condition. Where dust was deep, or where rebuilding had been in progress earlier in the year, a heavier oiling was given.

Figures on the expense of road oiling, prepared for the Courier by County Judge Anderson, show that the strictest economy was used, and are as follows:

20,262 gallons of oil.....	\$361.77
Freight on cars.....	50.40
Demurrage.....	8.00
Total labor charges.....	102.10

Total cost.....\$522.27

Of this sum Gladstone paid \$134 and Richardson \$42.20, the latter for the Outfield road, making \$176.20 to be deducted from the county's share of the expense, which shows a balance charged against the county of \$346.07.

There was an additional expense of \$34.60, incurred on account of the road-oiling machine having been delivered in faulty condition, but this expense will be made good by the company furnishing the machine.

The record made, therefore, is one of which the county and the county court may well be proud; and the Courier is glad to be able to say that some of its fears, expressed earlier in the year, were totally unfounded.

Last week the Estacada Progress—which started the complaint against the proposed plan of oiling the roads, and which believed that \$1600 was to be expended on this work under the direction of an automobile club—contained the following gem:

Ed Olds Got It

"While no official announcement has been made of the ultimate disposition of the \$1600 road oiling appropriation, we learn through one of the Oregon City business men, who is an ardent autoist and member of the South Fork Commission, that the money finally went astray and that our old friend Ed Olds of Oak Grove had most of the money put into road machinery for his district, with the balance in oil for his neighborhood."

"While the money should have been divided among other districts, we are glad to know that it was used for something more substantial than laying the dust."

In this connection, the ardent autoist mentioned above, admitted that the famous Clackamas Automobile Club of 30 to 40 members really comprised three automobile owners, who put up a sufficient bluff to land the original appropriation. If this is the truth, the honorable county court had better crawl in a hole and pull the hole in after them."

Replying to this, and contradicting it, County Judge Anderson has given the Courier the following statement:

"As to the clipping handed me from the Estacada Progress I beg to say that there was no appropriation of \$1600.00 or any other definite amount made for road oiling. The auto license was received from the Secretary of State, January 14, 1915, amounting \$1647.82. This amount was at once turned into the general road fund of the county by County Treasurer Dunn, according to the requirements of the state law. It has been used as other money in the general fund is used; for road and bridge purposes."

"As to the money having gone astray or having been given to Ed Olds for machinery, that is pure fabrication, Mr. Olds having no new machinery that I recall except a road grader purchased jointly between his district and Dist. 38."

"If the road oiling machine is referred to, that is the property of the whole county, and is an equipment for heating and spreading asphaltum. In order to get the 'ol' mess' of crude journalism entirely surrounded, I might summarize by saying:

"The road oiling cost the county \$346.07. Oil was spread on two roads on the east side of the Willamette river. No oil was used on the west side, although some should have been to protect the surface of the west side

CLACKAMAS COUNTY IS ONLY ONE TO PRESENT ACCURATE GRANT LIST

There are 98,206 acres of Oregon & California grant lands in Clackamas county, and Assessor J. E. Jack has them all listed in detail. As far as is known, this is the only county where there is on hand a systematized and accurate list of the railroad holdings, together with maps and detailed information as to the exact boundaries. The land has an assessed valuation of \$1,148,000. Taxes due on it are \$61,113.98.

Assessor Jack has all the information in regard to this county's share of the big railroad grant drawn up in convenient form, and will turn copies of it over to the Clackamas delegation to the state conference on the grant that has been called by the governor. Much work was involved in preparing this information; but Mr. Jack believes that it is his duty to keep on file every bit of information in regard to the county that his office can obtain.

OSWEGO FOLK SHOCKED

Wild Calls Sent for Sheriff and District Attorney

Saturday afternoon excited citizens of Oswego called up the sheriff's office and appealed frantically for immediate aid. So very excited were they, in fact, that Mr. Wilson, who works in the sheriff's office with Mr. Hackett, couldn't clearly understand what the trouble was. However, realizing that the matter would permit of no delay, he dashed across the street, got District Attorney Gilbert Hedges, and with that official fairly burned up the road in his automobile getting to Oswego.

At Oswego the trouble was self evident. It had been a warm day, a very warm day. And on the beach was a camp of gypsies, about a hundred of them. And the gypsies had been very warm, too; and being simple children of nature, they had proceeded to get more comfortable. All the gypsies under the age of sixteen or thereabouts, had simply shed their clothes so as to keep cool. And Oswego had looked on and been grossly shocked. The shock was all the greater because on Saturday afternoon Oswego is a gathering place for Portland visitors, so there were about three times as many people as usual on hand to be shocked by the simple gypsies and their primitive attire.

District Attorney Hedges and Mr. Wilson went among the gypsies and explained to them that other people didn't regard "bear-skins" (you pronounce it that way, anyway, even if you don't spell it that way) were not "the proper thing" even on warm days. If other garb was not donated at once, said the county officials, the law would have to take its course—and the county jail was very much warmer than Oswego. So the gypsies donned more attire, and the county officials departed knowing that they had done their duty, and Oswego got over its moral shock.

SEES NO JOKE

Sheriff Says Cedar Island Park is Perfectly Nice Place

A cartoon in a Portland paper, which intimated that Cedar Island park, which is in Clackamas county, was no place for a blind man to be, isn't appreciated by Mr. Wilson, who works in the sheriff's office with Mr. Hackett. The cartoon showed many modern bathing suits and other things and also showed a kindly citizen giving a blind man two dollars—just to repay him for what he was missing. And it was labelled Cedar Island park.

Mr. Wilson says that stories about the "wildness" of Cedar Island park are grossly exaggerated. He says that he has a husky deputy down there who delights to beat up disorderly folks, and who sends all boating parties that carry a booze ballast back to Portland. He further says that he has inspected the place himself several times, and that he has never received any complaints about the resort.

Many Given Bath

Spectators watching Oregon City's firemen practicing for the Willamette Valley tournament, which is to be held in the county seat September 6 and 7, were given a bath at Sixth and Main streets Friday night of last week, when one of the teams engaged in a practice water-fight playfully let the nozzle of the hose point towards the crowd. Those who were wet down declare that the Oregon City firemen surely know how to handle water.

road, which carries a heavy traffic. No oil was used on asphalt surface roads built last year. We spread no oil in Multnomah county, as reported. We never had any dealings with the Oregon City Auto Club in regard to fund for oiling road, although we doubtless talked with members of the club about the matter, as well as with others who are not members."

"DRY" COUNTRY IS 1916 SCHEME

PROHIBITIONISTS PLAN DIRECT
APPEAL AT POLLS FOR
ALL 'NATION

CRAFTY POLITICS ARE PLAYED

Campaigning of Last 45 Years Hoped
to bear Fruit when Appeal is
Made to Young Voters

J. Sanger Fox, executive secretary of the Oregon Prohibition State Committee, breezed into Oregon City Monday of this week to arrange for meetings in this county, to be held in the near future, at which voters will be told of the impending plan to vote the United States dry in 1916 and to place in the president's chair a prohibitionist. Mr. Fox is filled with enthusiasm, and believes that it is quit probable that the United States will "go dry" at the 1916 presidential election, and that it is certain that it will do so in 1920, if next year's test fails.

Some of the prohibition plans were revealed by Mr. Sanger, and they are good politics—as far as they go. According to the state executive secretary of the dries, it is proposed to hold the prohibition national convention after both the democratic and republican conventions have been held; so that if either or both of the older parties do not nominate a prohibitionist for president, and do not place a national prohibition plank in their platforms, the dries may do this, and so evolve a "winning party."

According to Mr. Fox there is a gigantic prohibition sentiment in the nation, and there are also many millions of voters who have signed a pledge to "vote only with a party and for candidates openly declaring for the destruction of the liquor traffic in state and nation." Further, according to Mr. Fox, the democrats will be forced to renominate Woodrow Wilson if they hope to continue their supremacy, and Mr. Wilson is not in favor of national legislation to make the country "dry."

Of the republicans Mr. Fox said but little, but it did not appear from his remarks that he expected the G. O. P. to adopt a national "dry" plank, nor did he seem to think it likely that they would nominate a dyed-in-the-wool prohibitionist. So, from his viewpoint, the outlook for the new prohibition party was pretty good for 1916.

"We may call it the prohibition party, or we may call it by a new name," said Mr. Fox, "but whatever we call it, it will be for prohibition throughout the nation. And aside from the voters who have signed our pledges, we are relying on the campaign we have been carrying on for the past 45 years, a campaign that has begun with the babies, and that has followed them through childhood and into manhood. That is the only way to conduct a campaign, to begin with the very youngest, and educate them to the correct point of view."

Mr. Fox would not express a guess to whom the national leader of the prohibitionists might be. He spoke of several large movements, each headed by men of note; and referred to centralization of effort through the churches, through the Christian Endeavor society, and through various other organizations. Regarding William Jennings Bryan, who recently quit President Wilson's cabinet under circumstances that reflected small credit to Mr. Bryan, Mr. Fox ventured an interesting remark.

"I do not know how closely you have been watching him, but if you have watched him as closely as I have, you will note that until recently he has kept his prohibition in his pocket. He has done this, I believe, because he knew that President Wilson was not an ardent advocate of national prohibition, and he did not want to embarrass the democratic party."

Mr. Fox's estimate of Mr. Bryan's desire not to embarrass the democratic party somehow seems to suggest that maybe Mr. Bryan is a receptive candidate for prohibition honors. That Mr. Fox himself may think this appeared to be true from his statement that "many leaders in both parties have seen the handwriting on the wall." Much aid to the prohibition cause is expected by Mr. Fox from Congressman Hobson, who is expected to bolt his own party convention and swing over to the prohibition national conference.

Mr. Fox will make a trip up the Columbia valley before returning to Oregon City to arrange for local "national prohibition" meetings, but when he does return he promises to start a lively campaign in this section.

The Courier for job printing.

Hurt in Mills

C. H. Becker, an employee of the paper mills, was the victim of a bad fall while at work last week, and sustained a broken leg and other injuries. He was removed to the Oregon City hospital.